



Reflections on Buildings

Grade 2

Drawing with Marker



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REFLECTIONS ON BUILDINGS

Length: 60 minutes

Number of docents: 1

Purpose:

- To help students describe artworks of buildings from various communities, cultures and time periods.
- To show how artists use their work to share experiences or tell a story.
- To identify point of view, perspective, and focal point in the works.
- To have students draw and print their own picture of buildings reflected in a lake.

Academic Support: Study of buildings, identification of rural, urban, suburban communities; weather and atmospheric effects; past and present.

Visual Arts Standards:

- Make art or design with various art materials and tools to explore personal interests, questions, and curiosity. (2.VA:Cr1.2)
- Experiment with various materials and tools to explore personal interests in a work of art or design. (2.VA:Cr2.1)
- Demonstrate safe procedures for using and cleaning art tools, equipment, and studio spaces. (2.VA:Cr2.2)
- Perceive and describe aesthetic characteristics of one's natural world and constructed environments. (2.VA:Re7.1)
- Interpret art by identifying the mood suggested by a work of art and describing relevant subject matter and characteristics of form. (2.VA:Re8)
- Use learned art vocabulary to express preferences about artwork. (2.VA:Re9)
- Create works of art about events in home, school, or community life. (2.VA:Cn10)
- Compare and contrast cultural uses of artwork from different times and places. (2.VA:Cn11)

Unit Contains: Portfolio with

- 6" x 9" drawing paper per student
- 2 Paint brushes and cups for applying water

Materials teacher will provide:

- Washable Markers

Featured works:

<i>Paris Street, Rainy Day (1876-77)</i>	Gustave Caillebotte
<i>Radiator Building, Night, New York (1927)</i>	Georgia O'Keeffe
<i>North Truro (Piazzolla) (2017)</i>	Mitchell Johnson
<i>Stone City, Iowa (1930)</i>	Grant Wood
<i>Taos Pueblo (1929)</i>	Georgia O'Keeffe
<i>Snow at Shinobazu, Benten Shrine (1931)</i>	Kawase Hasui

Vocabulary:

- Perspective** - how an artist makes objects look close or far
Point of View - the position from which a viewer looks at a subject
Bird's Eye View - seen from an elevated position as if you are a bird flying by
Focal Point - a point or object in a work that attracts your attention
Reflection - an image created when light bounces off a shiny surface
Realistic - the world as it actually exists
Imaginary - something that is made up, fanciful or unreal
Architecture - the design or plan for a building
Urban - related to a city
Suburban - related to a small, typically residential town near a city
Rural - related to a farm, forest, desert or plain where people live far apart from one another

Lesson set-up

- The lesson introduces 6 prints of buildings and asks students to think about what story the artist is trying to tell with each work. After examining the buildings and identifying where they might find them, the students will discuss the perspective, focal points and point of view in the prints. This lesson works best when the students can see the details of the prints, so try to gather them on the carpet.
- If you are teaching this lesson in the Fall, the students may have a limited attention span. You might need to skip some questions or skip a print.
- You may want to draw a project sample ahead of time to demonstrate how the water will be used to make a reflection of the buildings.
- Write on board *Reflections on Buildings, Perspective, Point of View, Focal Point*.

INTRODUCTION AND DISCUSSION OF PRINTS (30 MINUTES)

- Today's lesson is called Reflections on Buildings. Can anyone tell me what a reflection is? Be sure and tell us if you find a reflection in one of our prints.
- Your job is to be an *art detective*. What does a detective do? We will look for clues to different techniques the artists use to create interest and tell a story with their art.
- After we have looked at how some famous artists have used buildings in their work, you will draw and print your own picture of buildings reflected in a lake.

PARIS STREET; RAINY DAY, 1877

Gustave Caillebotte

Oil on canvas

7 x 10ft



Suggested Dialog:

- What is happening in this painting? (it's raining) "How do you know?" (stones are shiny, gray colors, umbrellas, sky and colors are dull, gray)
- Where are these people? (in a city: Paris, France) How do we know that this is a city? (wide streets, big buildings, the way the people are dressed). Does anyone know another name for a community that includes a large city? We call this an Urban community.
- Is the scene in this painting from "now" or from the past? How do you know? (old-fashioned clothing)
- What objects are closest to us? What are farthest away? How can you tell? (Things that are farther away are smaller and higher on the page.) We say a painting has *perspective* when an artist shows you that some things are closer and some are farther away.
- Where is the viewer standing? (in front of the two people with umbrellas) We call this a street or eye-level *point of view*. This is what you would see if you were walking down the street.

RADIATOR BUILDING – NIGHT, NEW YORK, 1927

Georgia O'Keeffe

Oil on Canvas

48" x 30"



Suggested Dialog:

- What do you see? (skyscraper) Where would you normally find a skyscraper? (This is another example of a city/urban community.) Let's ride the elevator from the bottom floor all the way to the top counting the floors as we go. (Start by crouching and slowly rise until standing as tall as possible.)
- What time of day is it? Is it warm or cool? How do you know?

- Where does your eye go in the painting? Is there anything in particular that captures your attention? (to the red light or the white and green steam). We call this a *focal point*. An artist uses a focal point to get you to take a closer look at the details in a painting. In this painting, notice that the red light points to the steam which points to spotlights at the top of building, moving your eye around the painting.
- This is the Radiator building, one of the first skyscrapers built in New York City. The painting is by Georgia O'Keeffe, who is a famous American artist who lived in the hotel across the street. (The building is known for its black and gold color and the bright spotlights that light up the top of the building at night. The artist hid the name of her husband, Alfred Stieglitz, in the lights.)

***STONE CITY*, 1930**

Grant Wood

Oil on wood panel

30" x 40"



Suggested Dialog:

- Let's pretend like we are birds flying in this painting. What buildings do you see? Where would you find these types of buildings? (Rural area.) What else do you see? When your position viewing a scene is from above, like a bird flying by, we call this "a bird's eye" point of view.
- Notice the horse and rider on the road. Discuss with your neighbor, "Where are the horse and rider going?" (The horse is on the road that winds its way to the top of the page drawing you into the picture and creating *perspective*.)
- How does the artist use shadows to create even more perspective? (The foreground is in shadows. The background is bright and sunny.)
- The name of this painting is *Stone City*. That is the name of the quarry town near where the artist grew up. This is how he remembered it as a child. What can you say about how he remembered it? (not realistic, puffy hills, plants and trees all look like vegetables.)

***TAOS PUEBLO*, 1929**

Georgia O'Keeffe

Oil on canvas

24 x 40"



Suggested Dialog:

- Who do you think lives here? (Pueblo Indians) These buildings, in the high sand cliffs of New Mexico, formed a self-sufficient community that housed up to 150 people.
- Why are the buildings this color? (They are built with adobe bricks made of straw and mud. The sand color camouflages the buildings to protect them from attack. The blue paint is "Taos Blue" which was thought to ward off evil spirits.)

- Notice the ladders. Show me with your fingers how many ladders you see? Why do you think they are there? Originally the buildings had no doors or window; they had to climb in through the top. Why? (They could pull the ladders up to the roof if an enemy attacked.)
- Notice the ovens outside. Why are they there? (They had no ventilation inside without windows and doors.) The buildings are 1000 years old and are still occupied. They are the oldest continuously inhabited buildings in the US.

NORTH TRURO (PIAZZOLLA), 2017

Mitchell Johnson

Oil on linen

38" x 64"

Suggested Dialog:



- Close your eyes...when you open them, where does your eye go first? Why does this *focal point* get your attention? (color) After you notice the flags, what do you notice next in the painting? (flags point to the pink window or maybe you notice the red windows in the background)
- What types of buildings do you see? Where would you find them? (in a *suburb* like Los Altos or Mountain View)
- What is our *point of view*? (This is another street view.) How would your point of view be different if you were a bird flying by? (You would see the roof tops.)
- The artist, Mitchell Johnson, is a local artist who lives and works in Menlo Park. If I asked you to color like Mitchell Johnson, what would you do? (Big, bold colors, few details.)

SNOW AT SHINOBAZU, BENTEN SHRINE, 1931

Kawase Hasui

Color Woodblock Print

14"x 10"

Suggested Dialog

- Discuss with your neighbor, where you might find a building like this and what do you think the building was used for? (Benten Shrine is in a suburban park in Tokyo. The shrine is a temple dedicated to Benten, the goddess of the arts, knowledge and wisdom.)
- This is a traditional Japanese wood-block print. It was made as a group effort in which the artist designed the print, a woodcutter carved the wood, a third person hand-painted and printed the woodblock and a publisher sponsored and promoted the work.
- Artists often include reflections in their work because they add interest and let you know that the texture of a surface is shiny and is reflecting light. What reflections do you see in this print? How did the artist create his reflection? (He used the same colors as the building but painted it upside down and blurred it to suggest the motion of the water.)
- Do you see any reflections in our other prints? (Wet cobblestones reflecting light in *Paris Street*. Pillar of bridge reflecting in river in *Stone City*.)



REFLECTIONS ON BUILDINGS PROJECT (20 minutes)

Now that you have seen many artist examples of buildings, it's your turn to create a picture of buildings. You can think of your buildings as being on the edge of a lake. You will draw on the top half of the page. The fold of the page will be the edge of the lake. We will use water to print a reflection of your buildings on the bottom of the page. (Show some finished samples.)

Suggested Dialog

- Will your buildings be in a city, a suburb, or on a farm in the country?
- Think about what story you want your picture to tell. Will it be a sunny day, a cold day? A stormy day?
- Use big, bold color with few details. (like Mitchell Johnson) Keep your design simple.
- Place your buildings on the edge of your "lake".
- What do we need to add to make a "lake"? Water!
- You will paint water on the bottom half of the page and fold and press the water to the corners to print a reflection. (Demo this if you have prepared a sample.)
- What do you see in the "lake"? (A reflection of the buildings.)

Project Steps

1. Please put your name on the back of your paper. Line up your corners and fold your paper in half so that your name is in on the outside. You may fold your paper in either direction (hamburger or hotdog fold) for short or tall buildings.
2. Open your paper and draw buildings only on the top half of your paper so that they are sitting on the edge of your "lake".
3. Add color to the sky to tell a story about your buildings - weather, season, or time of day.
4. When you are done coloring, bring your paper to the table, and we'll help you paint water onto the bottom half of your paper to print your reflection.



FOLD and
BACK RUB



Parent Instructions for Reflections on Buildings

Thank you for volunteering today!

Please help by:

Setting up lesson supplies

- Clear desks/tables
- While docent is showing prints for the introduction of the lesson, pass out 1 sheet of drawing paper/student

During the lesson

- Listen carefully to the docent instructions to the students
- Assist individual students by walking around the room
- Confirm students have written their name on the back
- Encourage students to color in the top area only
- Once students have finished coloring, help them add water to the bottom half of paper
- Encourage them to fold the paper over and give the entire piece a gentle backrub before opening it up to see the reflection they made

Additional tips

- Please don't work on students' art — demonstrate on scrap materials
- Ask Art Docents if a student needs extra help
- Have fun!

Helping clean-up

- Dry off brush and water cup and return to unit
- Wipe down tables as needed



BACKGROUND

Gustave Caillebotte (1848 – 1894)

The artist was born in Paris to a wealthy textile manufacturing family and received a conventional upbringing and education in law with no indication of artistic interests. After abandoning his law career, he joined the studio of the Salon master Leon Bonnat, where he met his stylistic model, Degas, and became intensely involved with the Impressionist cause for 8 years. Caillebotte organized the 1877 Impressionist exhibit. By 1879 he had virtually stopped painting, and the final 12 years of his life were marked by a retreat from urban involvement and an increasing devotion to gardening and yachting.

The painting *Paris Street, Rainy Day*, represents an intersection crossing the rue St. Petersburg (now rue Leningrad). Although the streets may not look modern, they were modern for Caillebotte's time. A building boom started in the 1820's under Napoleon. He added numerous gardens and wider, well-planned streets. This painting shows the new Paris that was rebuilt in Caillebotte's lifetime – an urban setting of a planned residential district for the upper bourgeoisie that was clean, regular and impressive in scale and a drastic change from the crooked, irregular, semi-medieval-scale Paris.

It is structured on a giant plus sign, split vertically by the lamppost and its reflection, and horizontally by a line through head levels and building bases. The architecture of the picture, both visible and covert, dominates all. It is not an Impressionist's glimpsed moment but a more frozen, monumental structure.

There is no teeming crowd or brilliant interplay of light and form but emptiness, far-reaching perspective and isolated wanderers. The isolation of the foreground couple, so close and yet so psychically remote from us and from each other...touches a familiar truth of modern urban life. It is similar to Seurat's "La Grande Jatte" in use of regular geometric order as a device for monumentalizing the banality of bourgeois ennui.

Georgia O'Keeffe (1888 – 1987)

Georgia O'Keeffe was born in Sun Prairie, a farming community in Wisconsin. Later on her family moved to Virginia. She received part of her formal art training at the Institute of Art, Chicago. During the 1920s O'Keeffe lived with the photographer Alfred Stieglitz in the Shelton Hotel in New York City. From 1926 to 1929, O'Keeffe painted urban landscapes, many of them based on the view from the 30th floor of the hotel. The urban landscapes represented a break in the source of imagery for her paintings; man-made vs. natural. "When I wanted to paint New York, the men thought I had lost my mind. But I did it anyway." The American Radiator Building was one of the first skyscrapers in New York City. The twenty-one story building is famous for its bold color scheme of black bricks and gilt.

In April 1929, O'Keeffe boarded a New York to Santa Fe bound train with Beck Strand. The two women met Mabel Dodge Luhan who invited them to move into her home in

Taos. Mabel's husband, Tony Jujan, a Pueblo Indian, took Georgia to Indian country and provided access to Taos Pueblo. The Indians did not welcome Anglos recording their lives and houses and Georgia had to pay fees for her sessions there.

Taos Pueblo is comprised of two large adobe communal houses, five stories high, facing each other north to south across Taos Creek. Until about 1890 the only entrance to the rooms was by ladders leading to hatchways in the roofs. After the need for defensive warfare with the Navajo and Apache decreased, doors and windows were cut into the adobe walls, but there are no inside stairways.

Taos Pueblo is constructed of PUDDLED ADOBE, successive layers of hand-packed mud left to dry directly on the wall. The resulting construction was cool in the summer, warm in the winter, provided natural camouflage and gave solace to the soul. The disadvantage of adobe construction is that it could crack at any time and even wash away in violent rainstorms. It requires constant maintenance and repair.

The Spanish introduced the *hornos* – outside ovens for the baking of bread and Taos Blue – a color believed to ward off evil spirits that can be observed in the painting. The *tapestes* are wooden pole supported platforms used for the storage of alfalfa, corn and produce. Firewood is sometimes stored beneath.

Grant Wood (1891 – 1942)

Born on a farm near Anamose, Iowa, Wood spent the first ten years of life in a rural community, attending a one-room school and raising farm pets, playing with his siblings outside and enjoying nature. There was no phone, radio or car. The memories of this period were to provide his richest resource as an artist. The relationship with his stern, Quaker father was always tense. During the 1910s and 20s, Wood went to art school, traveled and painted abroad, taught art in the public school systems, became an all-purpose painter and successful interior decorator in Cedar Rapids.

Stone City, 1930. In Stone City, Wood chose a hilly little village called Stone City, very close to where he grew up. When Grant was a boy, it was a bustling town full of stonecutters who chiseled limestone blocks out of the hillside for buildings and bridges. Now other building materials were used more often, and Stone City was almost empty.

Wood recalled the way he had viewed the country when he was a boy. The hills seemed fatter, the roads curvier. Trees had a round, puffy shape like grapes or blackberries. That was the way he painted Stone City. It looked real – and not quite real—at the same time.

Mitchell Johnson (1964 - _____).

Mitchell Johnson was born in South Carolina, but grew up in New York and Virginia. He studied painting and drawing at Randolph-Macon College, The Washington Studio School and Parsons School of Design where he earned an MFA in 1990. Johnson is one of our more important colorists & color field painters, taking a step beyond most abstract painters who deal with blocks of opposing color and suffusing his paintings with inner light. They simply glow. He commingles abstraction and realism.

His use of color and composition convey the pure enjoyment of being surrounded by natural beauty -- whether contemplating seaside villages at the Cape, including works made/inspired by a stay in Truro, Massachusetts, the Cape Cod village that was the summer home and favorite subject of Edward Hopper, or commanding a view of the Italian countryside. They are objects of distilled colors and silent perspective.

Since 1990, Johnson has divided his time between his studio in Menlo Park, CA and his favorite painting locations in Italy, France and Bornholm, Denmark.

Kawase Hasui (1883-1957)

Kawase Hasui was known as a prolific and talented 20th century shin hanga artist. The shin hanga artists revitalized the art of making ukiyo-e woodblock prints. Many of his print designs were landscapes based on his watercolors and sketches of scenic places throughout Japan.

As a child Hasui learned to paint in watercolor and oil in the Western style. Later, he trained in traditional Japanese style. In 1916 he met the publisher Shozaburo Watanabe and began a collaboration that continued into the 1950s. Hasui designed hundreds of shin hanga prints for Watanabe, most of which were exported to the US.

Hasui's earliest prints were destroyed in the Kanto earthquake on 1923 and they were never reprinted. His pre-earthquake prints are extremely rare and are some of the most sought-after shin hanga prints.

Ukiyo-e artists rarely carved their own woodblocks for printing; rather, production was divided between the artist, who designed the prints; the carver, who cut the woodblocks; the printer, who inked and pressed the woodblocks onto [hand-made paper](#); and the publisher, who financed, promoted, and distributed the works. As printing was done by hand, printers were able to achieve effects impractical with machines, such as the blending or gradation of colors on the printing block.

Snow at Shinobazu, Benten Shrine

Shinobazu is a pond within [Ueno Park](#) outside of Tokyo. Benten is the Buddhist patron goddess of literature and music, of wealth, and of femininity. It is quite unusual to find reflections in Japanese wood block prints. Hasui's training in Western painting influenced his work.

Revision History

Revision Date	Docent Name	Comments
1971		Developed
2007-08	Robyn Aber	Revised to include a print representing a suburban building, and the terminology <u>urban</u> , <u>suburban</u> , and <u>rural</u> to support the second grade study of buildings.
April 2011	Kimberly Dickerson	Reformatted for continuity
May 2016	Curriculum Committee	Hands-on project added, time increased to 60 minutes
November 2017	Lead Docents – led by Marshalla, Pierce, and Redfield	Added a reflection print, removed three prints and updated discussion questions.
March 2018	Kimberly Dickerson	Painting by Mitchell Johnson swapped out, correction on name of Caillebotte painting.
December 2018	Carol Redfield	Incorporated suggestions for updates to print discussions including interactive strategies.
April 2019	Kimberly Dickerson	New VAPA Standards added
June 2024	Curriculum Committee	Parent Volunteer Instructions added